

CANONICAL LESSON

See Urban Change Without Inventing Tenure

Decision-centred foundations for accountable sector intelligence

Production Unit	PU-B07-C52
Notebook	V7_D_N02
Status	Controlled educational draft v0.1
Data boundary	Synthetic instructional data only

Central decision: Measure urban growth and land-use change without inferring legal tenure, ownership, occupancy rights, or enforcement status from imagery or classification alone.

Learning outcomes

Why this matters

Remote-sensing classifications can be misused to invent tenure claims, criminalize residents, or justify displacement without due process.

The analytical workflow is useful only when evidence, uncertainty, authority, and action are connected explicitly. The model supports professional judgement; it does not replace accountable institutional authority.

Worked cross-sector example

A planning team confirms observed land-cover change with authorized records and field evidence before considering action.

Boundary: The example supports learning and review. It does not constitute an official statistic, eligibility determination, enforcement action, clinical judgement, or operational authorization.

Practice and reflection

- 1.
- Build a change matrix.
- 2.

- Add positional uncertainty.
- 3.
- State the tenure boundary.

Answer key

- 1.
- Cross-tabulate t0 and t1 classes with areas and confidence.
- 2.
- Use co-registration checks and buffer/sensitivity analysis near boundaries.
- 3.
- Land cover is physical evidence; tenure and legality require authoritative records, due process, and community/rights safeguards.

Operational readiness checklist

- Purpose and decision owner are named.
- Evidence definitions, provenance, and lawful access are documented.
- Uncertainty and abstention are visible.
- Human review, escalation, monitoring, incident response, and retirement are assigned.
- Equity, accessibility, security, and sector-specific approval are complete.